

Lecture Notes — Continued.

April 17th 1891.

On the Growth of Municipal Institutions.

“

The life of a city is not measured in years, but in the steadfast purpose of its citizens, working from one generation to the next, that law and liberty may dwell together in ordered peace.”

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I. Origin of the Borough.

From the earliest charters granted under the Crown, we find that the privilege of self-government was bestowed, not as a favor, but as a trust. See Charter of Henry II to Haldenmere, A.D. 1172 (Repository Copy, Vol. I. p. 3.)

II. Charter Rights and Liberties.

Market, Toll, and Fair — the lifeblood of early boroughs. These rights enabled the town to maintain roads, bridges, & a watch for the safety of all.

III. The Common Council.

Elected at first by the Burgesses; later reformed by the Municipal Act of 1835. Importance of Record-Keeping cannot be overstated. Without records, there is no memory; without memory, no will; without will, no progress.

N. B. Compare with notes of March 3rd on “The Parish and the Borough.”